

Design_Doc_WWD

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by **Anders Bandt**

Project Abstract

Scope: *This project will attempt to create an electronic wearable, worn on the wrist. The main function of this wearable will be to gather biometric data about the body using optical sensors. Specifically, using green LEDs and photodiodes.*

The TI integrated circuit AFE4432 will be used as the analog front-end for sampling the optical sensors and handling the signal chain.

Photoplethysmography will be used as the technique for extracting volumetric changes in blood in peripheral circulation from the sensor data. From this volumetric blood data, an estimate of heart rate will be produced.

An IMU will be included on the device for incorporating motion artifacts as error into the signal chain.

Bluetooth connectivity and USB are included on the device for data extraction.

Device Components

MCU

Using the TI MCU CC2642R from the SimpleLink portfolio.

This is a 32-bit ARM Cortex-M4F wireless MCU with Bluetooth capabilities.

AFE

The [AFE4432 - WWD](#) chip from TI will be used as the analog front end. Internal AFE clocking will be used, with flexibility to use single-shot clocking through a GPIO pin on the MCU.

There was a mistake in layout and currently only I2C capability is built into the design. Additionally, the pull-up resistors are pulled up to **TX_SUP** instead of **RX_SUP**, which will require some creative wire rework.

SPI capability is still possible, but would require some rework (one wire soldered onto PCB)

Connectivity

1. USB
 1. Enabled by the FTDI chip FT230X
 2. Converts USB data into UART for the MCU
2. Bluetooth
 1. 2.4 GHz chip antenna included in the design, feeding through a matching network into the MCU
3. JTAG - Debug
 1. cJTAG and JTAG exposed through connector

Sensors

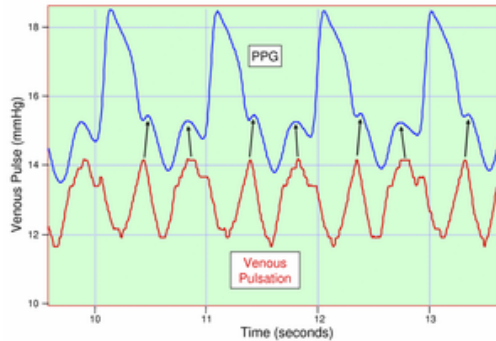
1. [4 x green LED emitters](#)
2. [3 x photodiodes](#)
3. IMU
 - [ICM-42670 \(IMU\) - WWD](#)
 - 3-axis gyro and accelerometer

Background and Theory

Below is an explanation of the operating principle behind heart rate extraction, photoplethysmography.

PPG Explanation

A **photoplethysmogram (PPG)** is an optically obtained plethysmogram that can be used to detect blood volume changes in the microvascular bed of tissue. With each cardiac cycle, the heart pumps blood to the periphery. The change in volume caused by the pressure pulse is detected by illuminating the skin with the light from an LED, and then measuring the amount of light either transmitted or reflected to a photodiode.



venous pulsation clearly seen in a PPG

Each cardiac cycle will appear as a peak, heart rate can be determined. The DC component of the signal is attributed to the bulk absorption of the skin tissue, and should be canceled out in signal processing.

The AC signal is directly attributable to the variation in blood volume in the skin caused by the pressure pulse of the cardiac cycle. The height of this AC signal is the proportional to pulse pressure (the difference between the systolic and diastolic pressure in the arteries). This is the true "signal of interest".

Signal Chain

There are many various components but much of the analog side of it is handled by the AFE4432. It seems to be that there will be a couple set of challenges.

- **Noise**
 - Various sources of noise in system (sensitivity in power supplies,)
- **Filtering**
 - Programmable filters on AFE
 - Filtering methods applied to digital FIFO data to improve signal
- **Timing**
 - Complex phase timing sets
 - Many options configurable on AFE

The details of the signal chain are not fully fleshed out at this point, but below is a rough outline of some various sub-blocks of the signal chain.

Sub-blocks of Signal Chain

Sensor Input

The signal chain starts with the sensors: photodiodes and LEDs. The AFE has two LED drivers each with 8-bit current control.

Low noise offset DACs can be enabled at the sensor inputs to automatically cancel DC.

Amplification

The raw sensor signals are typically weak and require amplification to increase the signal level for further processing. The AFE4432 has a low-noise programmable gain amplifier (PGA) that can be configured to amplify the sensor signals according to the application requirements.

Up to 12 signal phase sets can be defined, each phase set comprising a combination of LED and Ambient phases.

The current from the photodiodes in each phase is converted into a voltage by a TIA, which is then fed into filtering.

Filtering

After amplification, filtering is applied to remove unwanted noise and interference from the sensor signals. The AFE4432 includes a digital finite impulse response (FIR) filter with programmable coefficients, which can be used to implement different filter types such as low-pass, high-pass, band-pass, or notch filters to achieve the desired signal quality.

Decimation

In some cases, the sensor signals may be oversampled, and decimation can be applied to reduce the data rate and improve the signal-to-noise ratio. The AFE4432 includes a digital decimation filter that can be used to downsample the sensor signals while preserving the relevant frequency content.

ADC Sampling

The AFE4432 features an integrated ADC that can be used to sample the filtered and decimated sensor signals. The sampled signals are stored in a 160-sample FIFO block, which will be read out to the MCU through either a SPI or I2C interface.

DSP

The digitized sensor signals will undergo various digital signal processing (DSP) techniques, such as filtering, feature extraction, and analysis, depending on the specific application requirements.

Heart rate detection will require some digital algorithms. Similar to R-wave detection in ECG QRS complex processing, the algorithm will mainly need to detect the relative peak of the PPG signal and compute the time difference from peaks, finding frequency of peaks. The detail of this signal processing isn't fully mapped out yet, but some potential options include

- **Fast Fourier Transform (FFT)**
 - Converts the PPGG signal from the time domain to the frequency domain
- **Autocorrelation function (ACF)**
 - Measures the similarity between a signal and a delayed version of itself
- **Wavelet transform**
 - Used to analyze signals with both frequency and time variations.
 - Can provide detailed information about the PPG signal at different time scales, and from that used to extract heart rate information from the PPG signal

Phase Cancellation (Optional)

In some applications, phase cancellation techniques may be applied to remove artifacts or interference from the sensor signals. This could involve generating a reference signal with an opposite phase to the interference and subtracting it from the sensor signal to cancel out the unwanted component. The specific implementation of phase cancellation would depend on the type of interference and the desired signal quality.

Output

Finally, the processed sensor signals can be output to a display, storage device, or transmitted wirelessly for further analysis or display on a user interface, depending on the application requirements.

For this initial design, the data will be either output through Bluetooth or USB.

Power System

Regulators

BMS - BQ25120A

The BMS will be done through the TI chip [bq25120A - WWD](#). This IC is highly integrated, with a multitude of features.

Specifically used in this design will be

- Linear charger
- Unregulated buck output (PMID)
- Battery temperature monitoring (through thermistor)

Boost Converter - [TPS6125](#)

In order to get a higher voltage rail in the system, a boost converter will be used. It will be fed from the buck (PMID) output from the BMS

AFE4432 Supplies

LDO - TX_SUP

The AFE4432 has a transmit supply, mainly used for driving the LEDs. For this, the LDO [LP38693](#) will be used with an output of 3.3V

LDO - RX_SUP

The AFE4432 also has a receive supply, used for the photodiodes and other IC power. For this, the LDO [LP5900 - WWD](#) will be used at an output of 1.8V.

Voltage and Current Ratings

Operating Voltages

The table below lists the "desired voltages", meaning the voltages intended during normal operation of the device

Ideal Operating Voltages

Line	Min	Typ	Max	Spec Driver
RX_SUP	1.7	1.8	1.9	AFE4432 6.3 - Recommended Operating Conditions
TX_SUP	3.0	3.3	3.6	AFE4432 6.3 - Recommended Operating Conditions
VDDS	1.96	2.6	3.0	See Note 1
BOOST	4.8	5	5.2	TPS61252 - WWD > Ideal Output Voltage
PMID	2.7	3.3	5.0	ideal voltage to maintain VDDS
CHARGE_IN	4.8	5.0	5.2	gut guess if powered through USB
BAT_+	2.85	3.6	4.20	I made up 3.6 V as typical/ideal

Note 1: Upper limit driven by [bq25120A - WWD](#) VSYS limits with an applied margin of (-0.3 V). Lower limit driven by my calculations in [bq25120A - WWD > Operating Parameters](#)

Operating Currents

The table below lists the maximum current ratings

Maximum Current

Line	Min	Typ	Max	Spec Driver
RX_SUP			3 mA	
TX_SUP			200 mA	LED forward current, AFE4432 consumption (note 1)
VDD			15 mA	Not sure where I got this
PMID			300 mA	BMS integrated BUCK
CHARGE_IN				
BAT_+			450 mA	

Notes

1. Depending on my max [LED forward current](#) and the AFE4432 device itself current draw?
 1. $15\text{mA} * 4 = 60\text{ mA}$

Absolute Maximum Voltages

Below is the list of the absolute maximum voltages that should be on any pin.

Absolute Maximum Voltage

Line	Min	Typ	Max	Spec Driver
RX_SUP	-0.3		2.1	AFE4432 6.1 - Absolute Maximum Ratings
TX_SUP	-0.3		6	AFE4432 6.1 - Absolute Maximum Ratings
VDDS	-0.3	2.6	3.6	IMU (CC2642R is max 4.1 V)
BOOST	?		?	TPS61252 Max Ratings
PMID	1.8		5.0	BMS integrated BUCK
CHARGE_IN			8.0	
BAT_+	2.75		4.25	

Physical Assembly, Casing

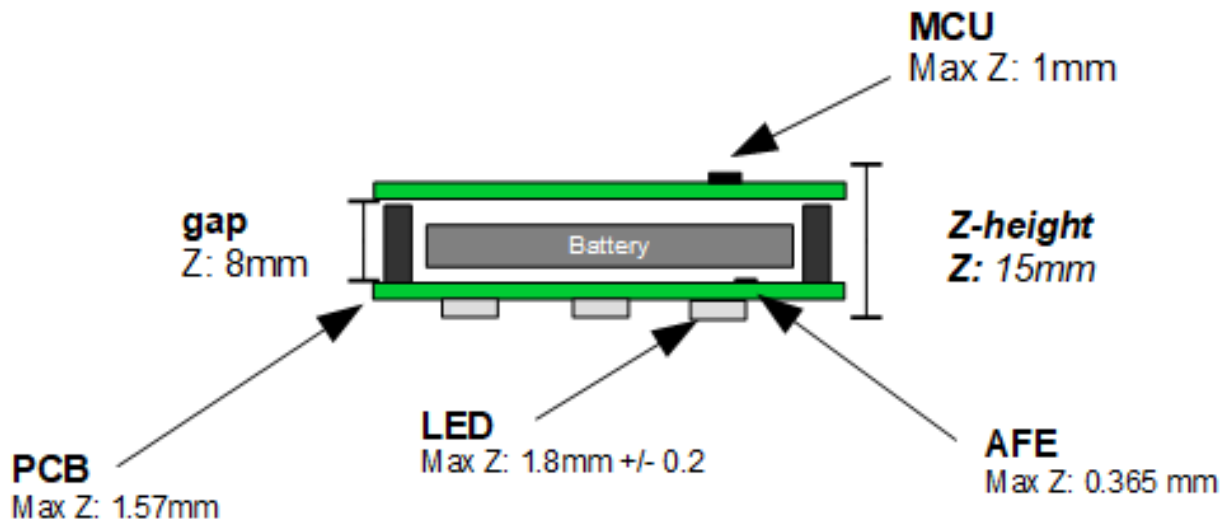
The design will be separated into two boards.

Board 1 (bottom board) shall contain:

1. AFE4432
2. LEDs
3. Photodiodes

Board 2 (top board) shall contain:

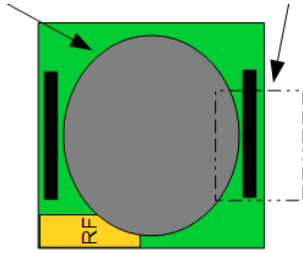
1. MCU
2. RF Antenna
3. Power system



side view of board

This separation of the boards was done for a couple reasons.

- Better signal integrity on the LED/photodiode side.
 - Less interference from switching buck/boost converters, RF, etc.
- Modularity of design
 - Allows for better testability of the MCU and AFE separately



XY Plane: 45x45 mm

top down view of the XY plane. Board dimensions are 45 x 45 mm

Female headers (Samtec SSM-110-L-SV) will be mounted on the bottom board, with mating connectors (Samtec MTLW series) coming down from the top.

Casing

Casing is undetermined at this point. Ideally, casing will increase signal integrity of the LED/photodiode signals. This means a few things

1. Small curvature in the casing to allow depression into the wrist, and better optical coupling (less ambient light leakage as well)
2. Lenses to focus emitted and reflected light
 1. For example, this is the optomechanical design on the casing of an Apple Watch



2.

Testing

After my initial year working as a product engineer with Texas Instruments, I have developed some appreciation for quality testing procedures. And from that experience I have developed some testing procedures to "wakeup" the device.

Board 1

Below is the procedure to "wakeup" b1 (AFE4432)

B1 Wakeup - AFE4432

[AFE4432 - WWD](#)

Wakeup on board 1

Initialization Procedure

Start with AFE4432 board, applying power externally and issuing simple commands

Process should be like so

1. Apply power, if current draw good and no shorts can proceed
 1. Consideration - AFE4432 has some power supply ramping requirements for TX_SUP and RX_SUP
2. Apply a reset
 1. Done by writing to a `SW_RESET` register bit
 2. Can also be a hardware reset.... details pending???
3. Write `PAGE_SEL` to 1
 1. [AFE Firmware - WWD > Page Selection](#)
4. Write all the relevant register settings in Page 1 of the register map
5. Write `PAGE_SEL` to 1
6. Program the registers in Page 0. Registers can be programmed in any order
7. At this point, can enable ISR in the MCU from the AFE
8. Set the `TIMER_ENABLE` and `PRF_COUNTER_ENABLE` bits to 1. Timing engine will start running and the FIFO will start off in an initialized state

Board 2

And below is the procedure to "wake up" board 2, containing the power system and MCU.

B2 Wakeup - MCU

[MCU - WWD > MCU Wakeup](#)

MCU wakeup will involve

1. Observing valid MCU power
2. Uploading program
3. Blinking LED

MCU Wakeup

Here is the procedure for waking up the MCU

1. Apply ideal voltage to **BAT_+**
 1. Observe 1.8V on **VDDS**
 2. This is Vmin for the MCU so should be able to issue commands
2. Apply system power (VDDS settings) to BMS over I2C
3. Observe 2.6 V on **VDDS**
4. Force power-on reset condition on the CC2642R
 1. **MCU_RESET** should be held high
 2. Need to hold low for at least $1\mu s$
5. Start bootloader (should auto start with no valid flash image)
6. Upload blink example using `LED_STATUS` (DIO_0) to the MCU
- 7.

Good luck have fun!

Hard problems to deal with

There are many challenges with this project. It's hard to say that the hardware I designed will work fully, or at all.

The signal chain will be very sensitive to any noise and interference. Hopefully the AFE will be intuitive to use, but layout and casing will also be important factors in ensuring a quality signal chain.

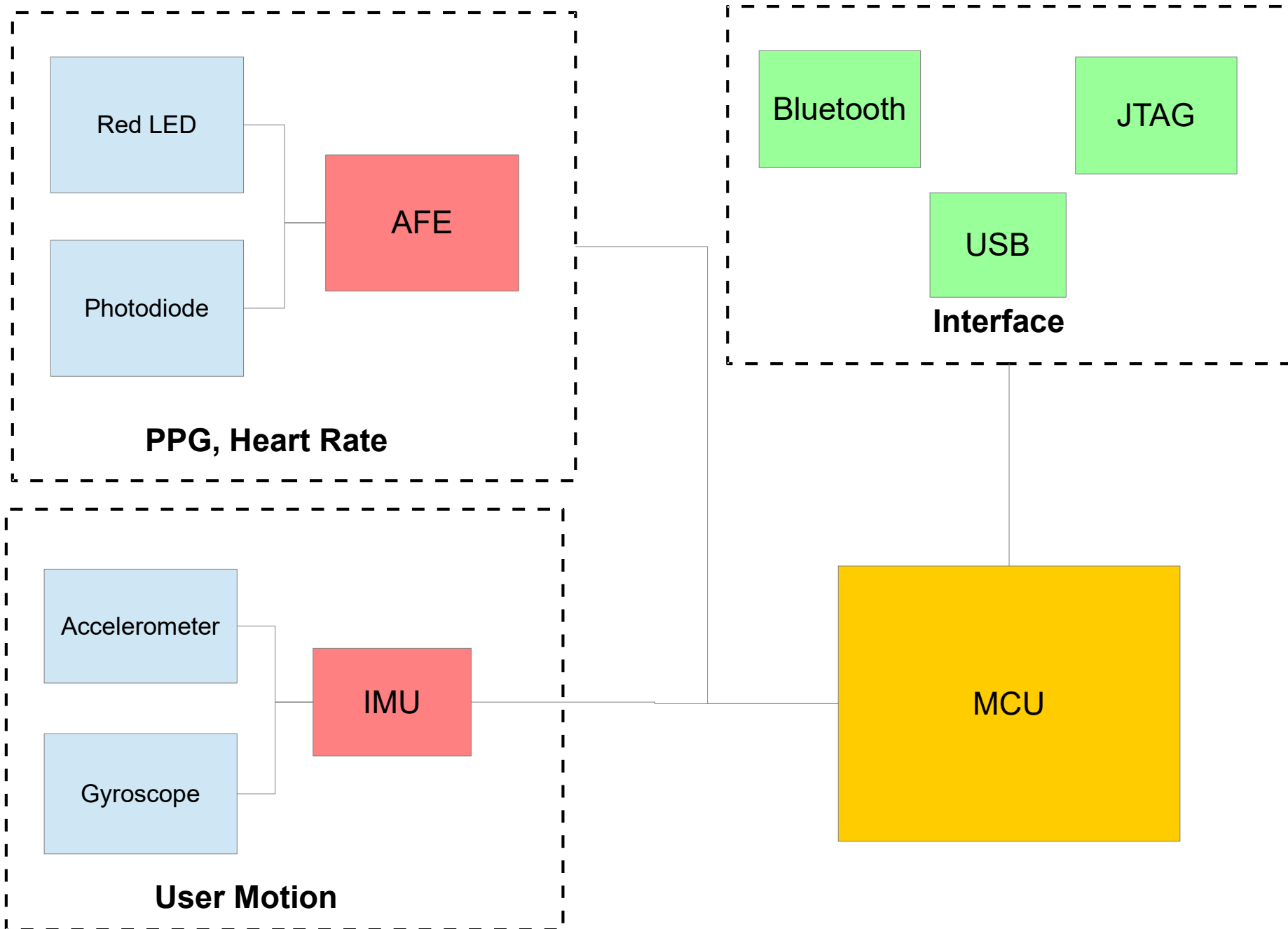
The digital processing will require a large software effort to fully process the data.

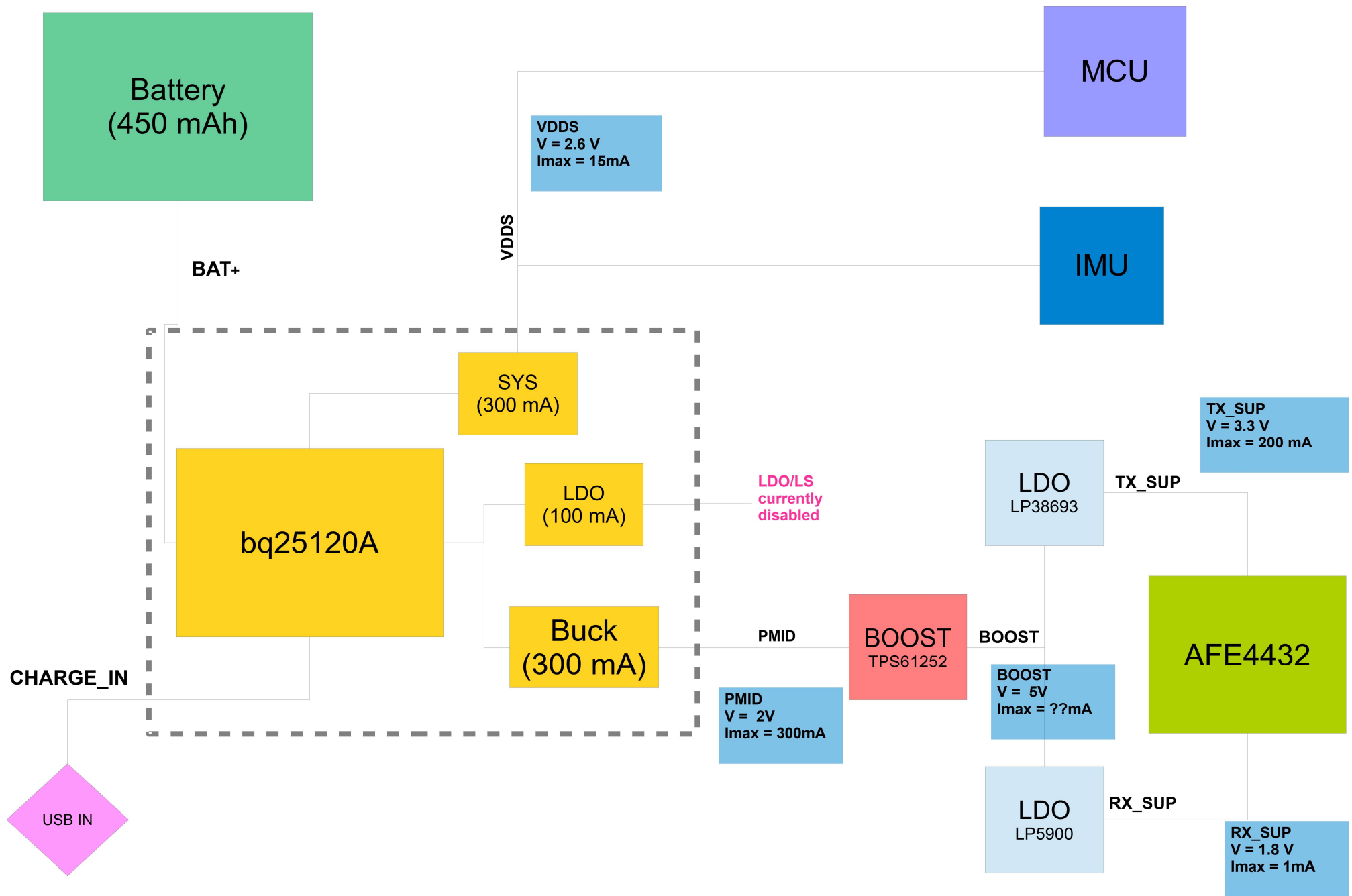
Optomechanic Challenges

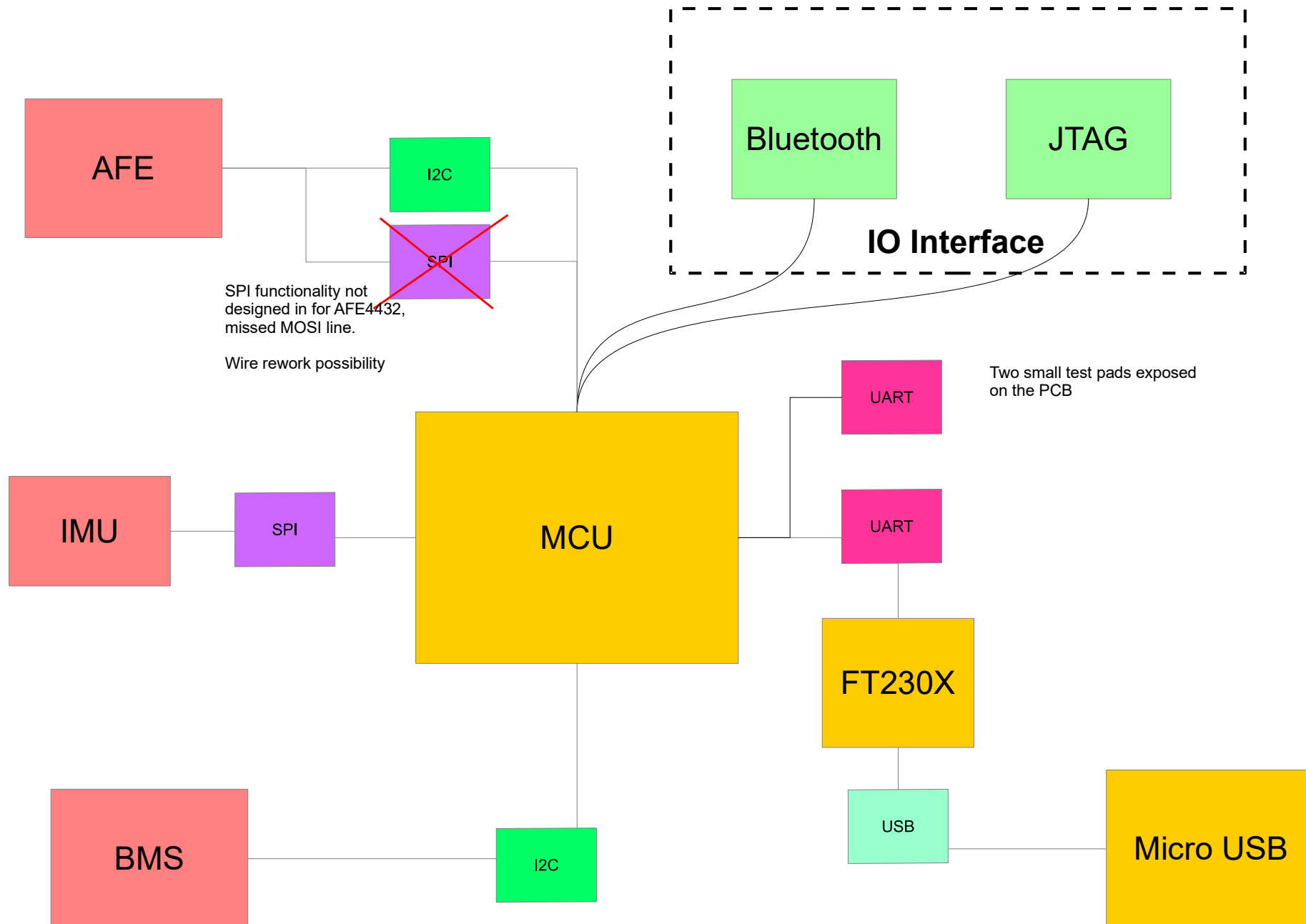
- Coupling
- Wavelengths
- Multiple form factors
- Multiple emitters
- Gross displacement

Signal Extraction Challenges

- Motion-tolerant
- Validation
- Performance
- Power management
- Scalable biometric roadmap

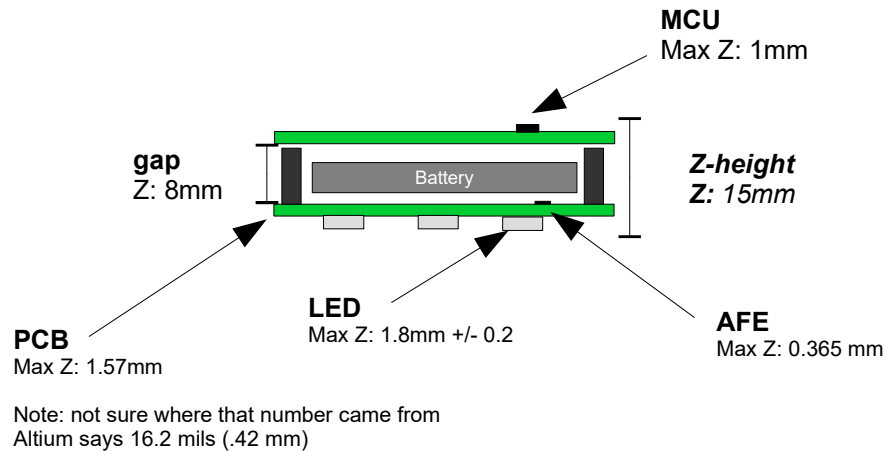






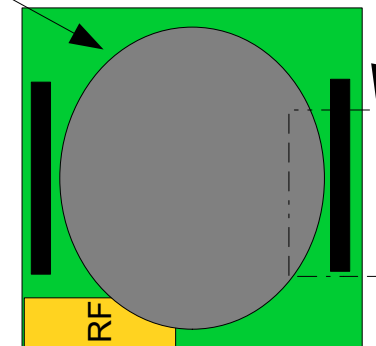
Wearable Wrist Device

Board Dimensions



Z Plane: 15 mm

Note
made battery y axis 40 mm because of
the added battery protection circuitry

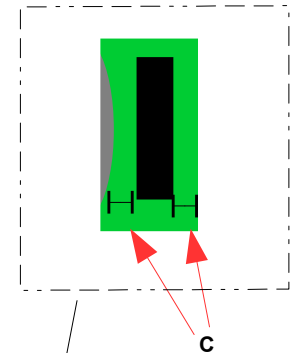


XY Plane: 45x45 mm

Connector Edge Clearance

$$\text{Clearance (C)} = ((\text{pcb_x} - \text{bat_x})/2 - \text{con_x})/2$$
$$C = 1.23 \text{ mm}$$

Where
pcb_x = 45 mm
bat_x = 35 mm
con_x = 2.54mm

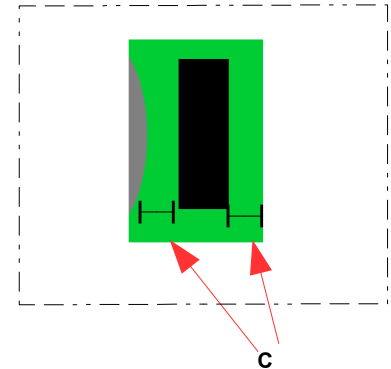
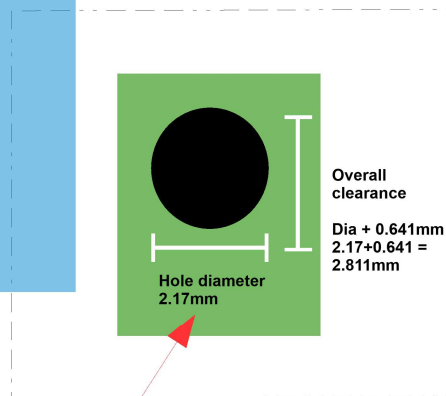


Wearable Wrist Device

Connector and Mounting Holes

Dimensioning Note 1 – Connector

$w1 = 2.54\text{mm}$ (width of connector)
 $Dx = 45\text{mm}$ (length of board in x axis)
 $C = 1.23\text{mm}$ (connector clearance)



J1

Geometric (x, y)
 $(x, y) = (x0 + C + w1/2, Dx/2)$
 $= (2.5, 22.5)\text{ mm}$

P2

$(x, y) = (4.0, 22.5)\text{ mm}$

Dimensioning Note 2

Origin
 $(x, y) = 0$

J2

Geometric (x, y)
 $(x, y) = (x1 - C - w1/2, Dx/2)$
 $= (42.5, 22.5)$

P2

$(x, y) = (41.0, 22.5)\text{ mm}$

Notes

- Dimensions are exactly doubled on this sheet
- Made battery y axis 45 mm because of the added circuitry

XY Plane: 45x45 mm

Rev – 02

Sep 5th, 2023

Anders Bandt

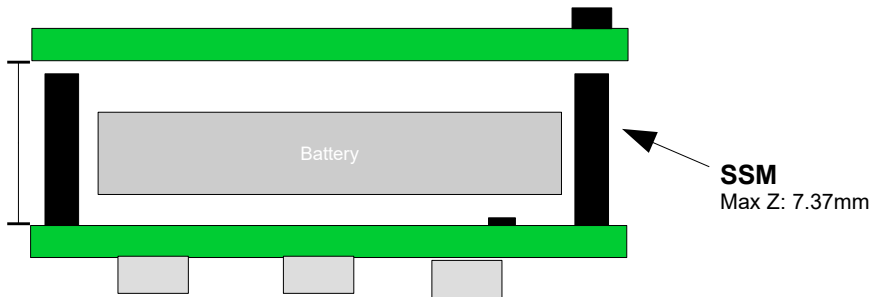
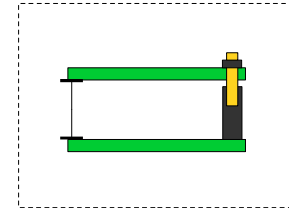
Wearable Wrist Device

Connect Mating

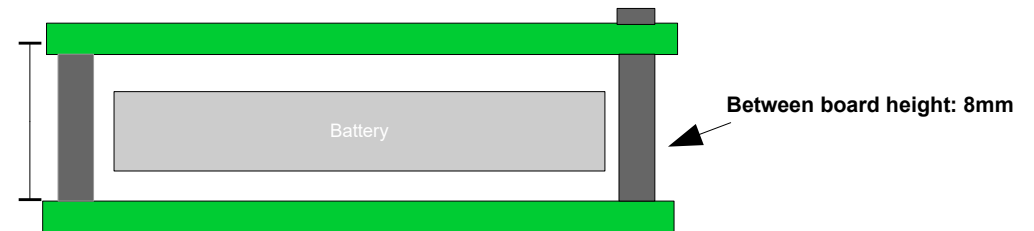
Mating Plunge Depth
Max Z:



gap
Z: 8mm

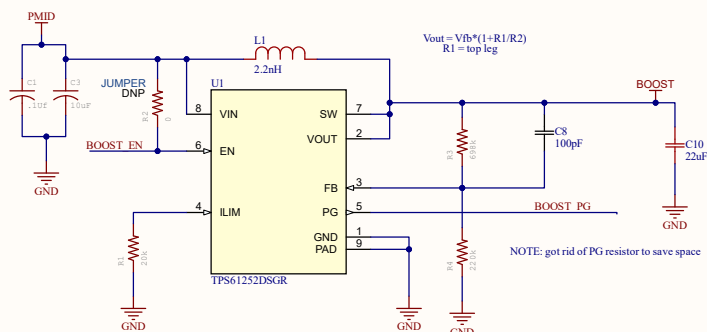


Connector Mating Depths

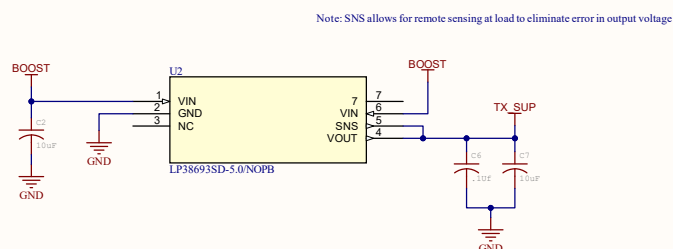


Standoffs

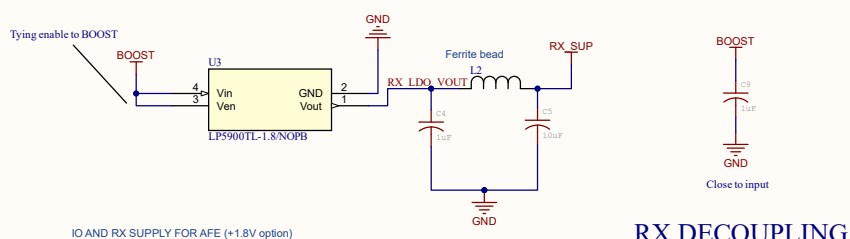
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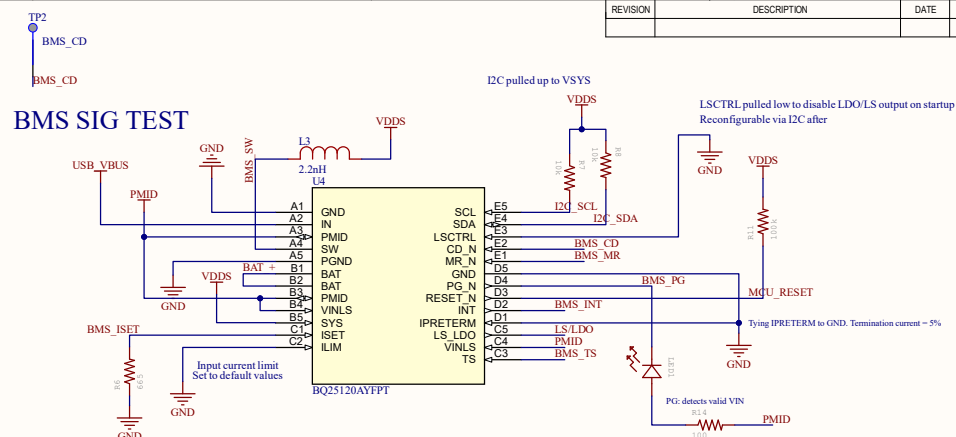
BOOST



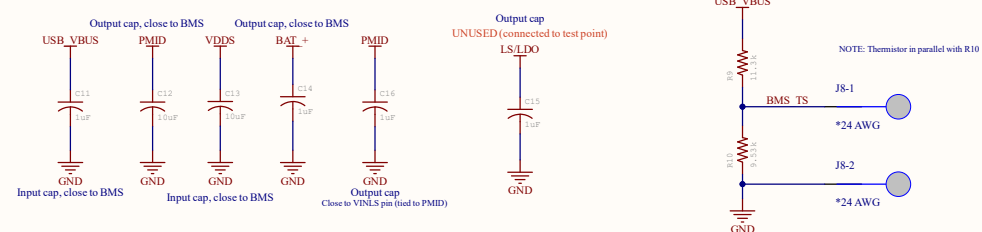
LDO - TX



LDO - RX



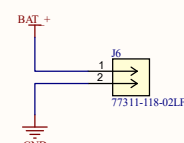
BMS SIG TEST



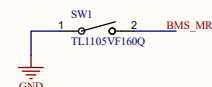
BMS DECOUPLING

BMS

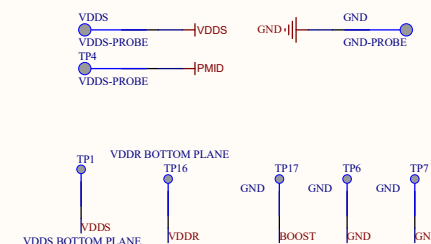
THERMISTOR WIRE HARNESS



BATTERY INPUT



RESET SWITCH



POWER TEST POINTS

MISC COMPONENTs

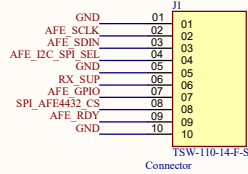
APPROVALS		DATE	PROJECT		Anders Bandt		
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CHK:	-	4/20/23	TITLE				
REFERENCE DOCUMENTS			Wearable Schematics				
BOM: 1							
ASSY DWG: 1							
FAB DWG: 1							
PCB DWG: 1							
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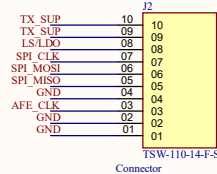
NOTE: these have to exactly mirror the AFE board

Exceptions
J2-1 (LS/LDO)

NOTE: J2 is oriented with pin #10 at top



TSW-110-14-F-S
Connector

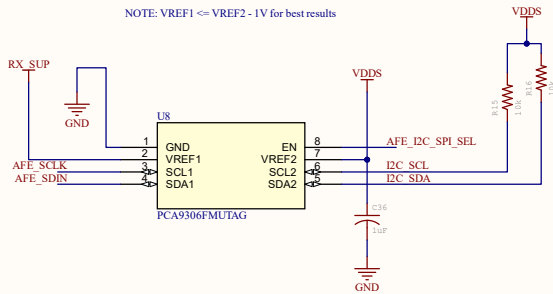


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Connector

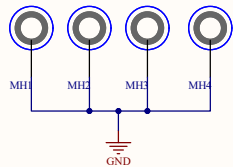
Board-Board Connector



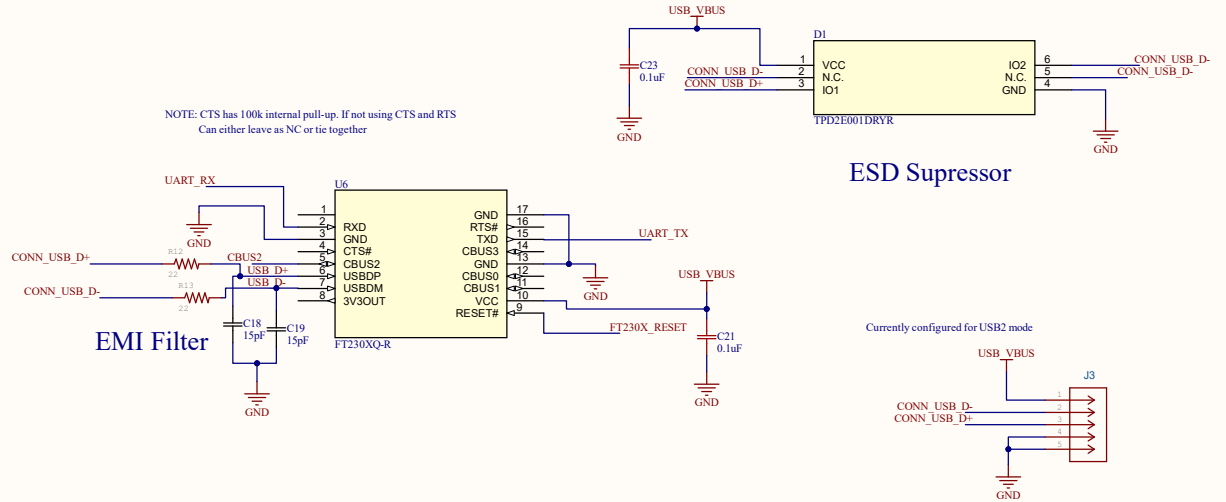
NOTE: VREF1 <= VREF2 - 1V for best results



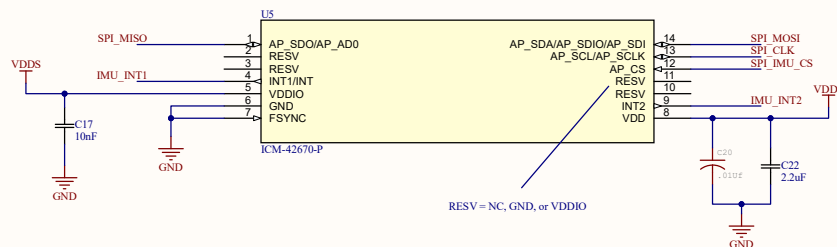
I2C - LEVEL TRANSLATOR



MOUNTING HOLES



USB to UART

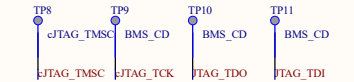
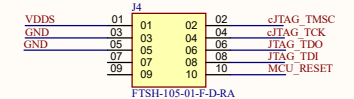


IMU

ESD Suppressor

Currently configured for USB2 mode

Micro Type-B Connector

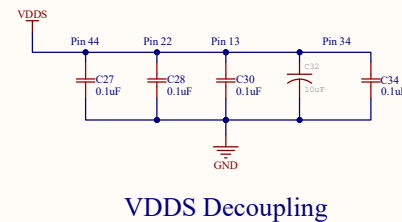
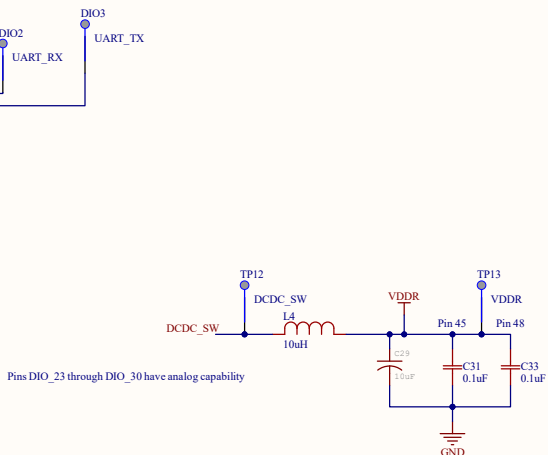
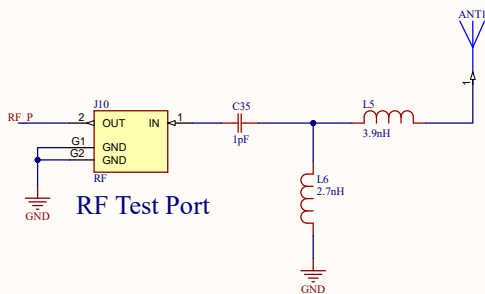
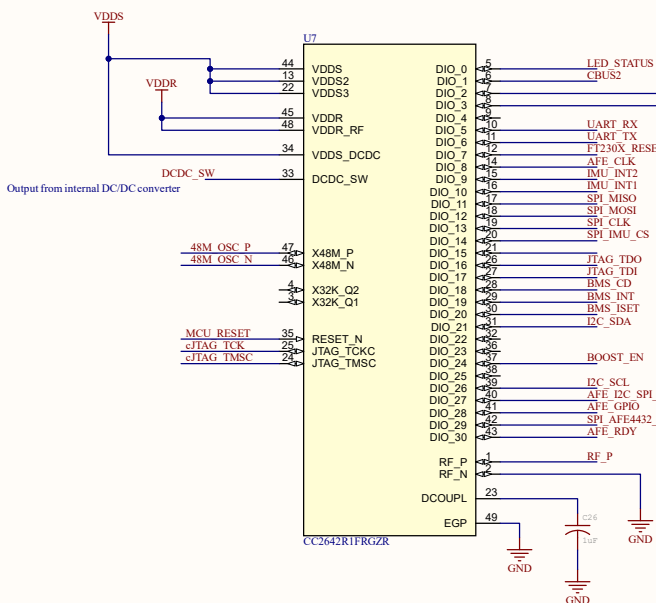
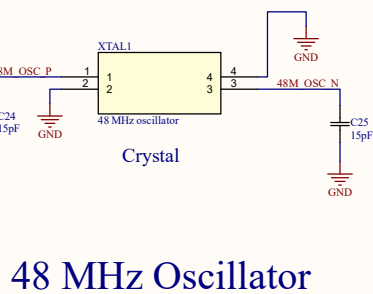
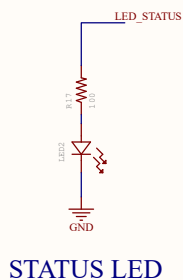


Segger J-Link EDU

APPROVALS		DATE	PROJECT		Anders Bandt	
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DSN.	-	4/20/23	PROJECT REVISION: 1.0	DOCUMENT REVISION: 1.0	DESIGN ITEM: 1.0	
CHK.	-		TITLE			
REFERENCE DOCUMENTS			Wearable Schematics			
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ASSY DWG: 1						
FAB DWG: 1						
PCB DWG: 1						
			SCALE: 1:1		FILE NAME: COMM_IMU.SchDoc	SHEET 2 OF 3

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REVISION	DESCRIPTION	DATE	APPROVED



MCU + Bluetooth

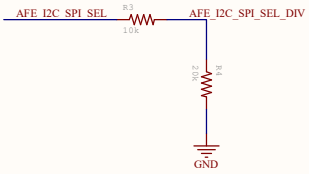
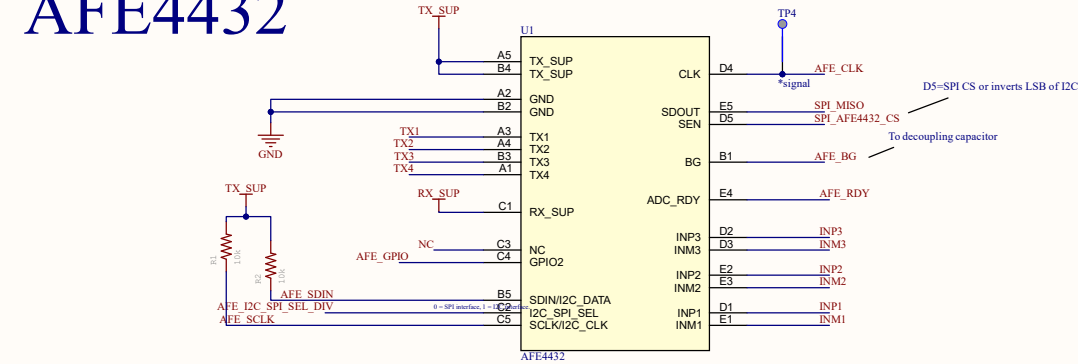
Antenna System

APPROVALS		DATE	PROJECT		Anders Bandt	
ENG:	+	4/20/23	Wearable Wrist Device			
DSN:	+	4/20/23	PROJECT REVISION:	1.0	DOCUMENT REVISION:	1.0
CHK:	+	4/20/23	TITLE	Wearable Schematics		
REFERENCE DOCUMENTS			BOM:	1	SIZE	1
ASSY DWG:	1		CAGE CODE	58791	DWG NO.	1
FAB DWG:	1		SCALE:	1:1	FILE NAME	MCU.SchDoc
PCB DWG:	1		SHEET	3	OF	3

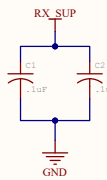
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REVISION	DESCRIPTION	DATE	APPROVED

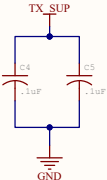
AFE4432



I2C-SPI Voltage Divide



RX_SUP Decouple



TX_SUP Decouple

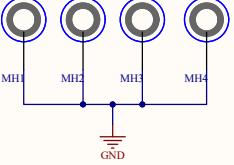


BG Decouple

AFE DECOUPLING

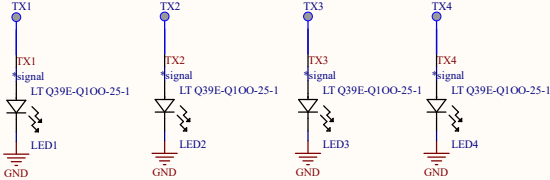


SMD Standoffs
(battery spacer)

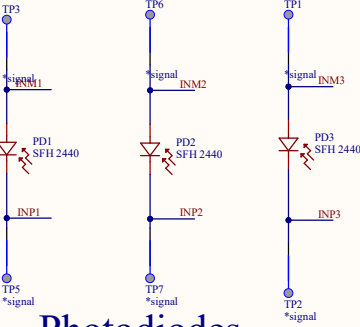


Mechanical holes

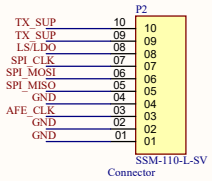
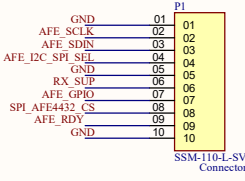
MECHANICAL



LEDs

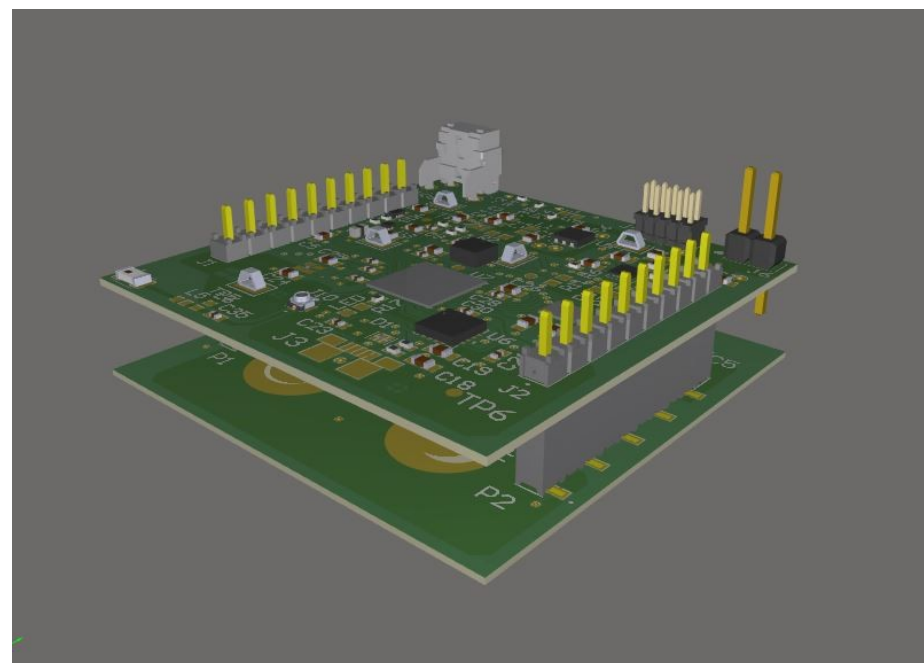
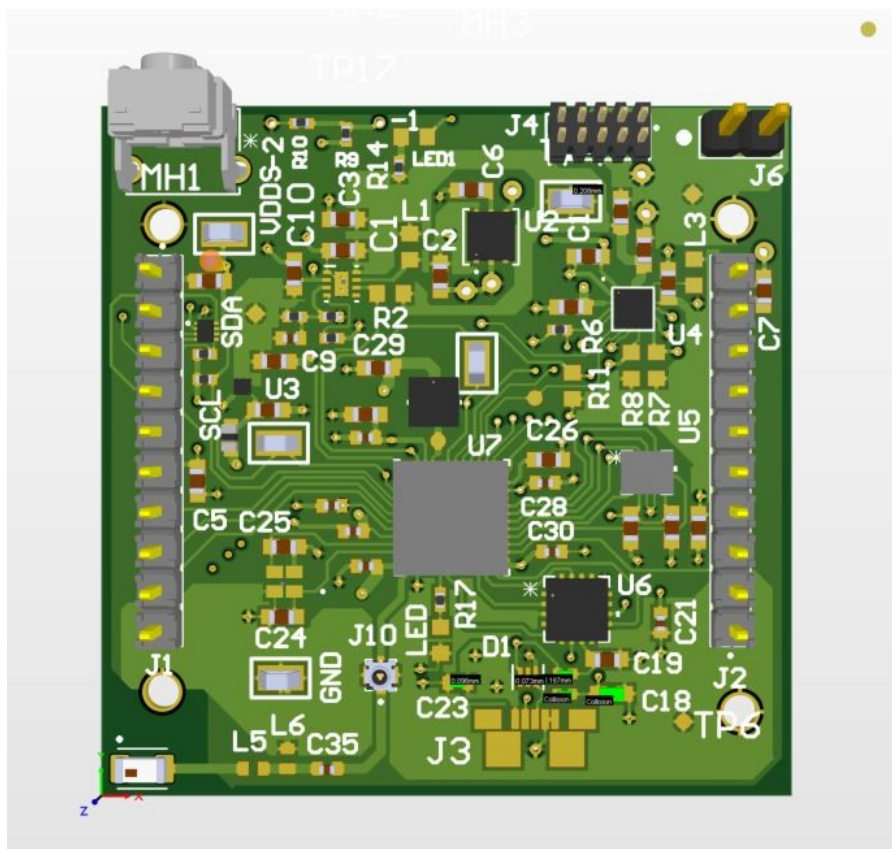


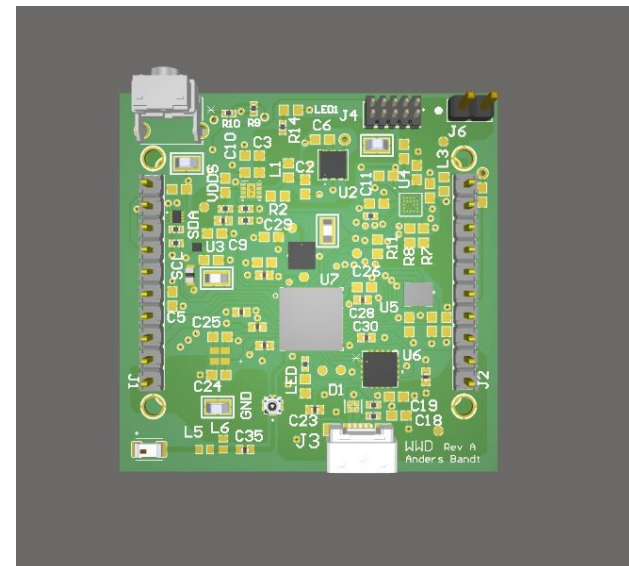
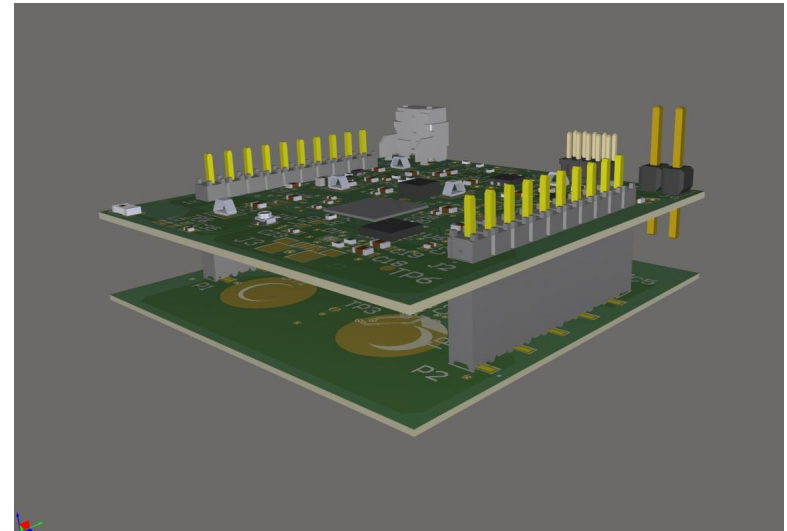
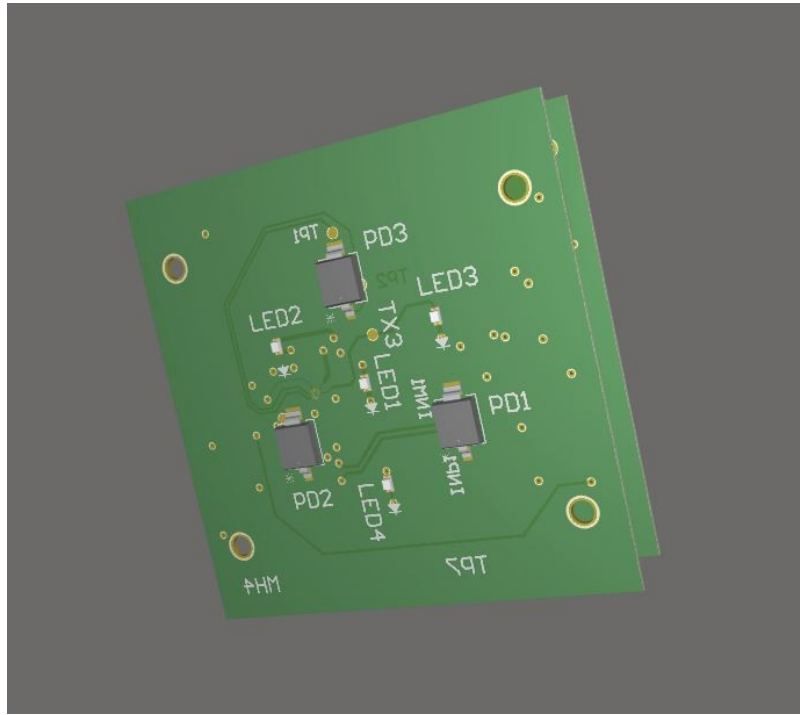
Photodiodes

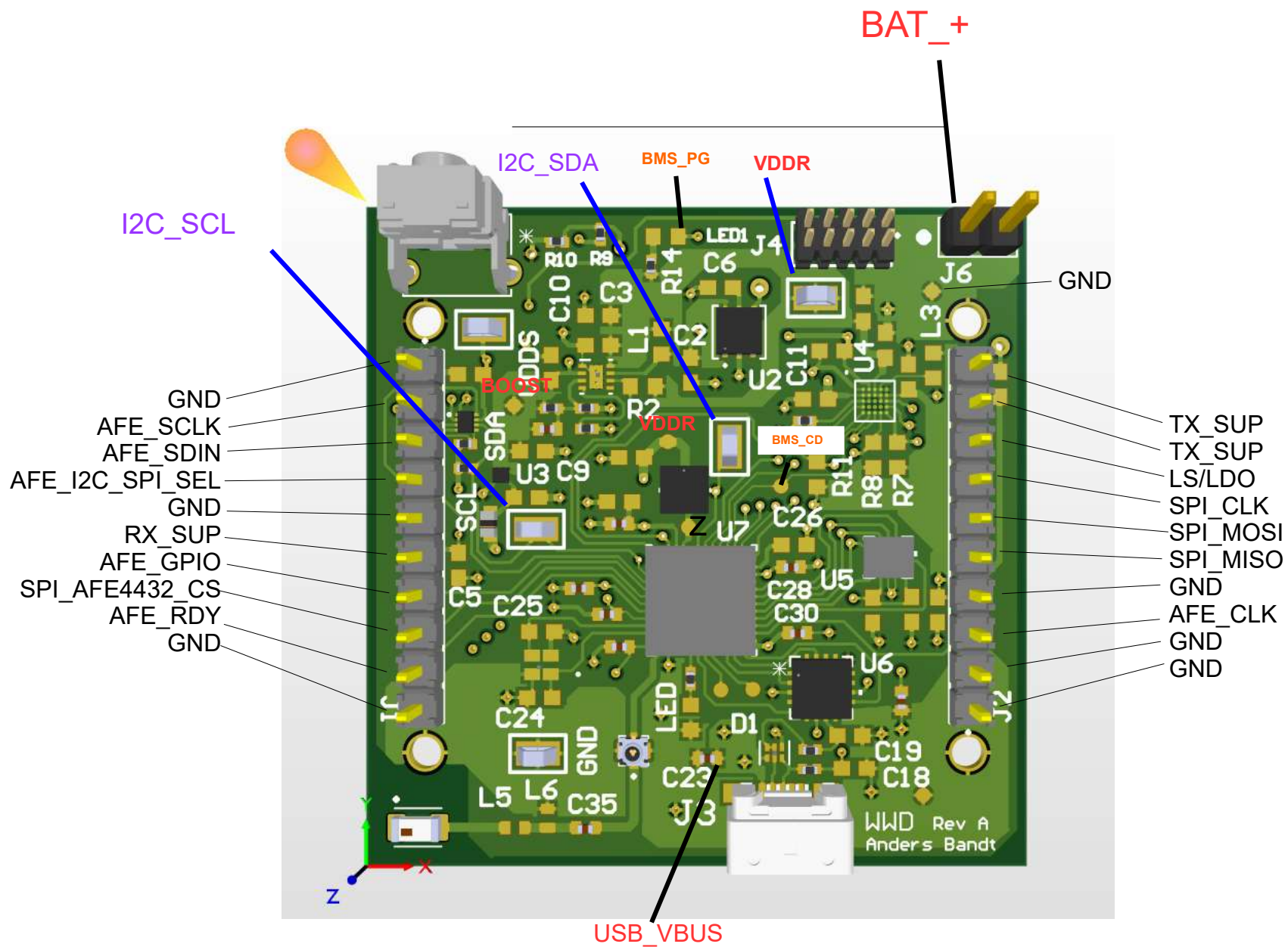


Board-Board Connector

APPROVALS	DATE	PROJECT	Anders Bandt	
ENG: .				
DSN: .		PROJECT REVISION:	DOCUMENT REVISION:	DESIGN ITEM:
CHK: .		TITLE		
REFERENCE DOCUMENTS		★		
BOM:		SIZE	CAGE CODE	DWG NO.
ASSY DWG:		A3		
FAB DWG:		SCALE:	FILE NAME	SHEET 1 OF 1
PCB DWG:			AFE4432.SchDoc	







VDDR

BOOST

BMS_PG

AFE_SDIN

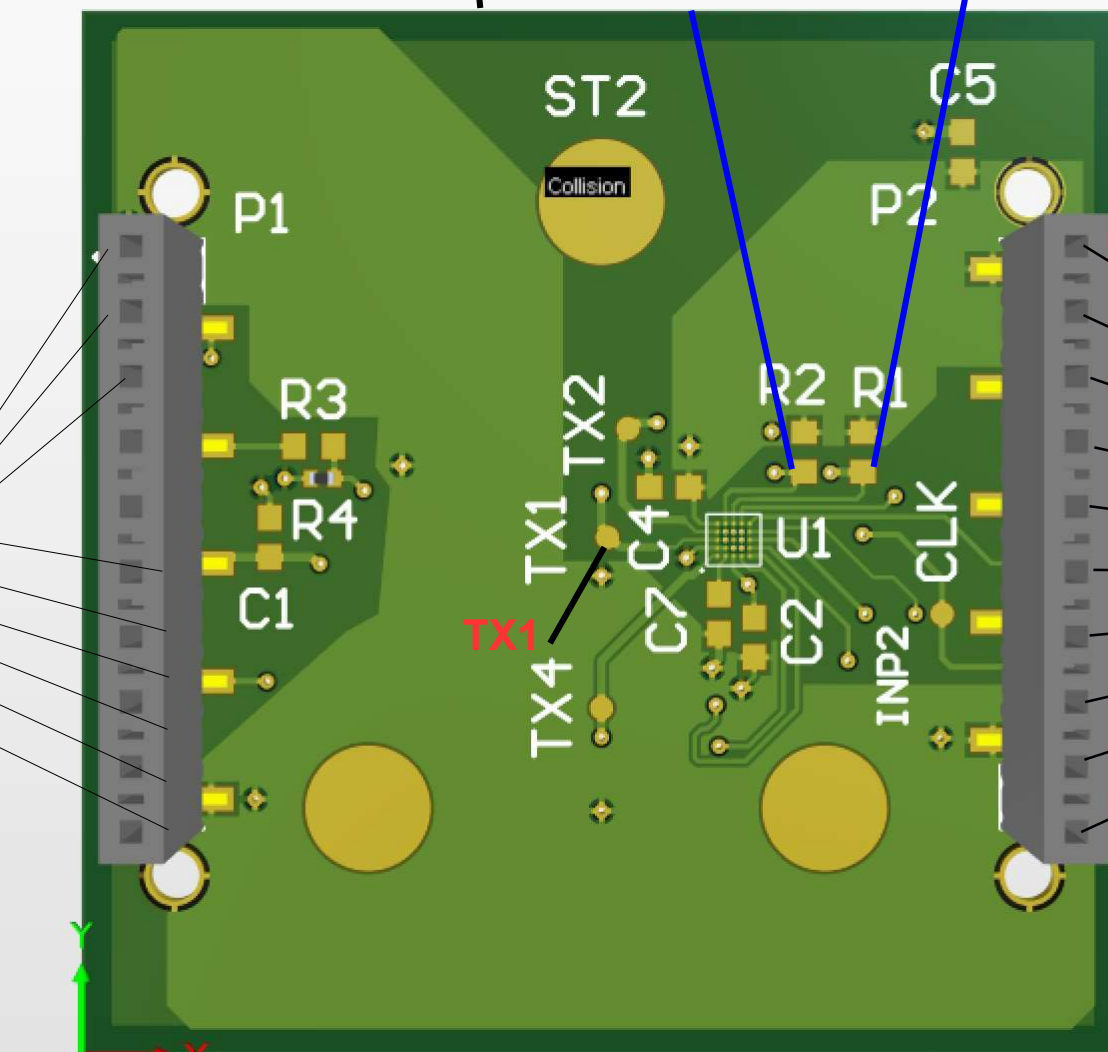
AFE_SCLK

BMS_PG

BAT_+

1. GND
2. AFE_SDIN
3. AFE_I2C_SPI_SEL
4. GND
5. RX_SUP
6. AFE_GPIO
7. SPI_AFE4432_CS
8. AFE_RDY
9. GND

1. TX_SUP
2. TX_SUP
3. LS/LDO
4. SPI_CLK
5. SPI_MOSI
6. SPI_MISO
7. GND
8. AFE_CLK
9. GND
10. GND



TX1

TX1 TX2

ST2

Collision

P2

R2 R1

C7 C4

U1

C2

INP2

CLK

AFE_SCLK

AFE_SDIN

BMS_PG

BAT_+

VDDR

BOOST

TX1

TX2

TX_SUP

TX_SUP

LS/LDO

SPI_CLK

SPI_MOSI

SPI_MISO

GND

AFE_CLK

GND

GND

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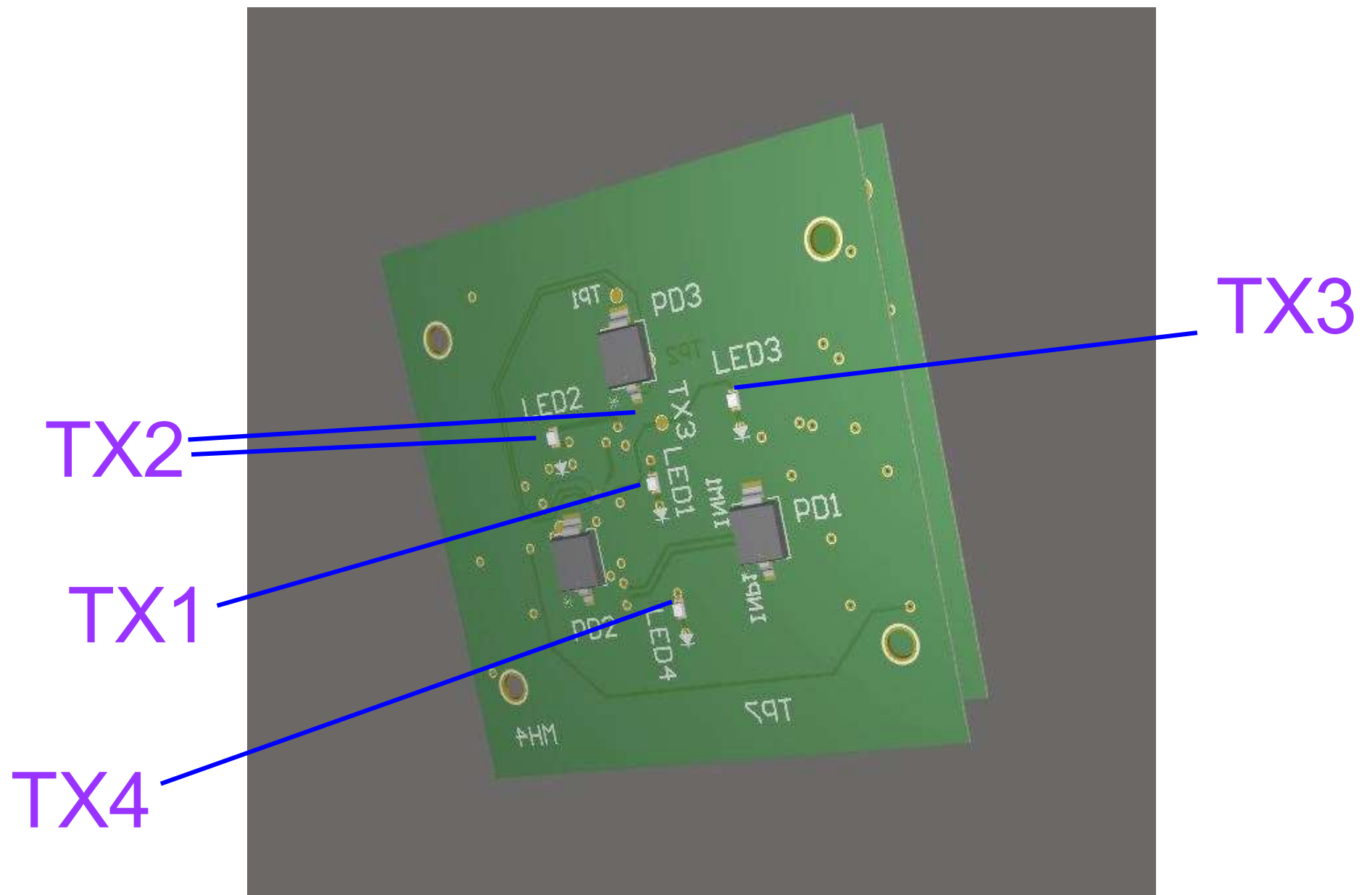
GND

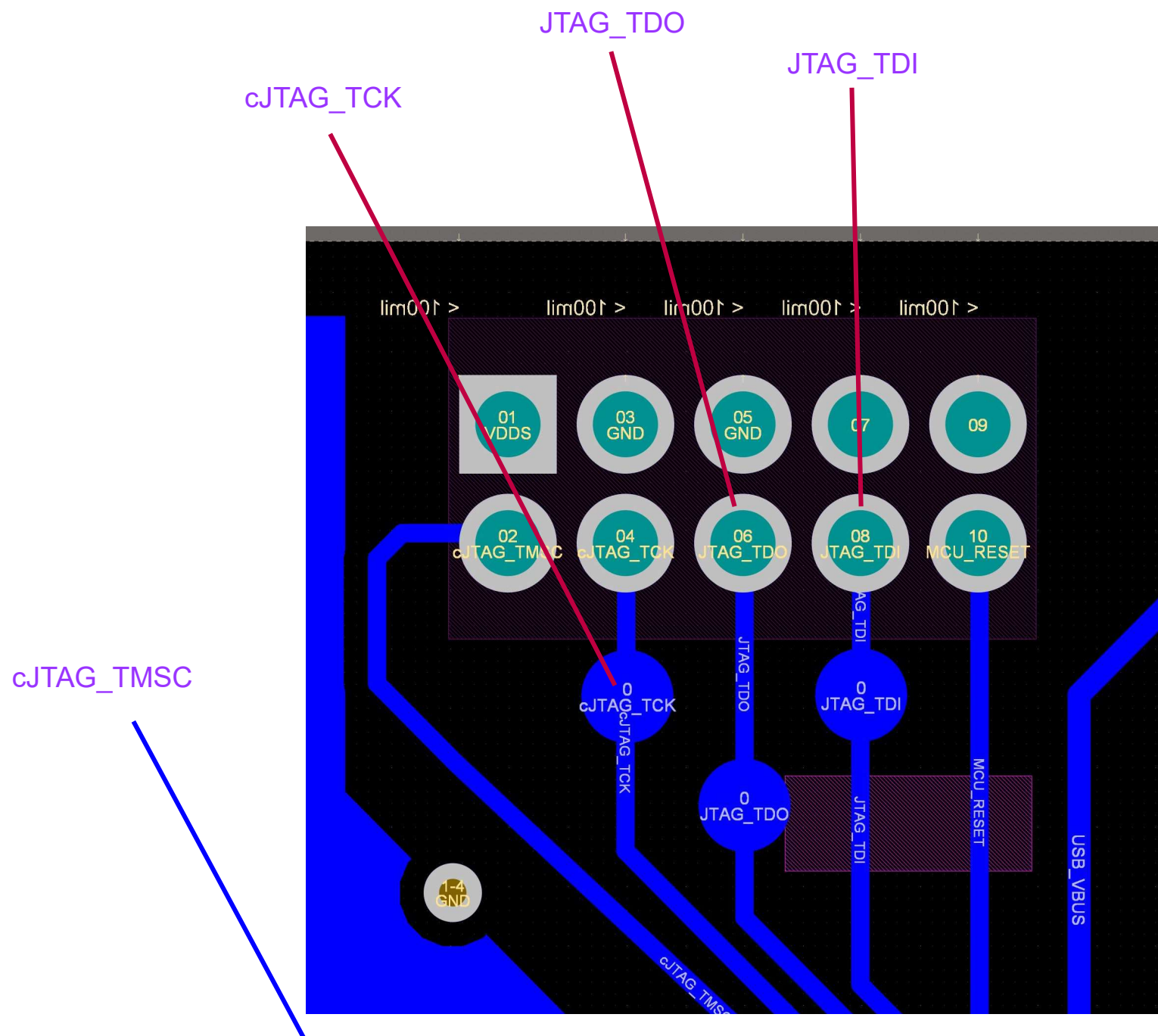
GND

GND

GND

GND





 = IC short
 = top
 = bottom